

Latin Jazz & Tango

Riffs, Licks & Melodic Patterns

For Alto & Tenor Saxophone — Transpose to all 12 keys

1. Latin Jazz Riffs — Minor Vamps

D Dorian (concert F for alto, C for tenor). Play over Dm7 montuno groove with clave.

1a. Pentatonic Call



1b. Falling Answer



1c. The Montuno Riff



1d. Root-5th Anchor (marcato)



1e. Dorian Signature (1-2-b3-5-4-2-1)

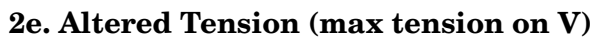
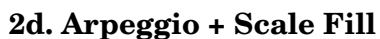


1f. Blue Note Dip (with b5 passing tone)





2a. Smooth Dorian-Spanish





2f. Pentatonic Shift (Dm pent → Db pent → Cm)



2g. Chromatic Approach (half steps into resolution)



2h. Spanish Signature (full Spanish run on V)



3. Dominant 7th — 8 Flavors of G7

Same chord, 8 different scale colors. Play each, hear the difference.

3a. Mixolydian (vanilla)



3b. Spanish / Jewish (salsa fire)



3c. Bebop Dominant (smooth 8th notes)

4



3d. Diminished H-W (angular, symmetric)



3e. Altered (maximum heat)



3f. Whole Tone (floating, dreamy)



3g. Blues (earthy, soulful)



3h. Lydian Dominant (bright, non-resolving)



4. Pentatonic Tricks

D minor pentatonic (D F G A C). Simple but powerful patterns.

4a. Ascending 4ths



4b. Falling 3rds



4c. 3-Note Cells (shifting up)



4d. Call & Response (leave space!)



4e. Octave Displacement (dramatic jumps)



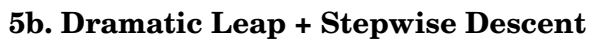
4f. Clave Pentatonic



4g. Ab min pent over G7 (b9, 3, b5, b13, b7 of G7)



5a. The Tango Sigh (upper neighbor, fall back)





5h. Double Neighbor (surround from above & below)



5i. Piazzolla Sequence (rising 3rds through harm. minor)



5j. Tango Ending (turn on 5th, descend to tonic)



6. Rhythmic Patterns

Applied to D Dorian. Use these rhythms with ANY scale.

6a. Son Clave 3-2



6b. Anticipated Downbeat (push the 'one')



6c. Tresillo (3+3+2)

8



6d. Habanera (dotted quarter + eighth)



6e. Cinquillo



6f. Off-Beat Accents (all upbeats)



6g. 3-over-4 Polyrhythm (dotted quarters)



6h. Cascara-Inspired



7. Lick Transposition — Smooth Dorian-Spanish in 4 Key

The same lick (2a) moved to the 4 most common Latin jazz key centers.

C minor: Dm7 — G7b9 — Cm



F minor: Gm7 — C7b9 — Fm



G minor: Am7 — D7b9 — Gm



D minor: Em7 — A7b9 — Dm

